

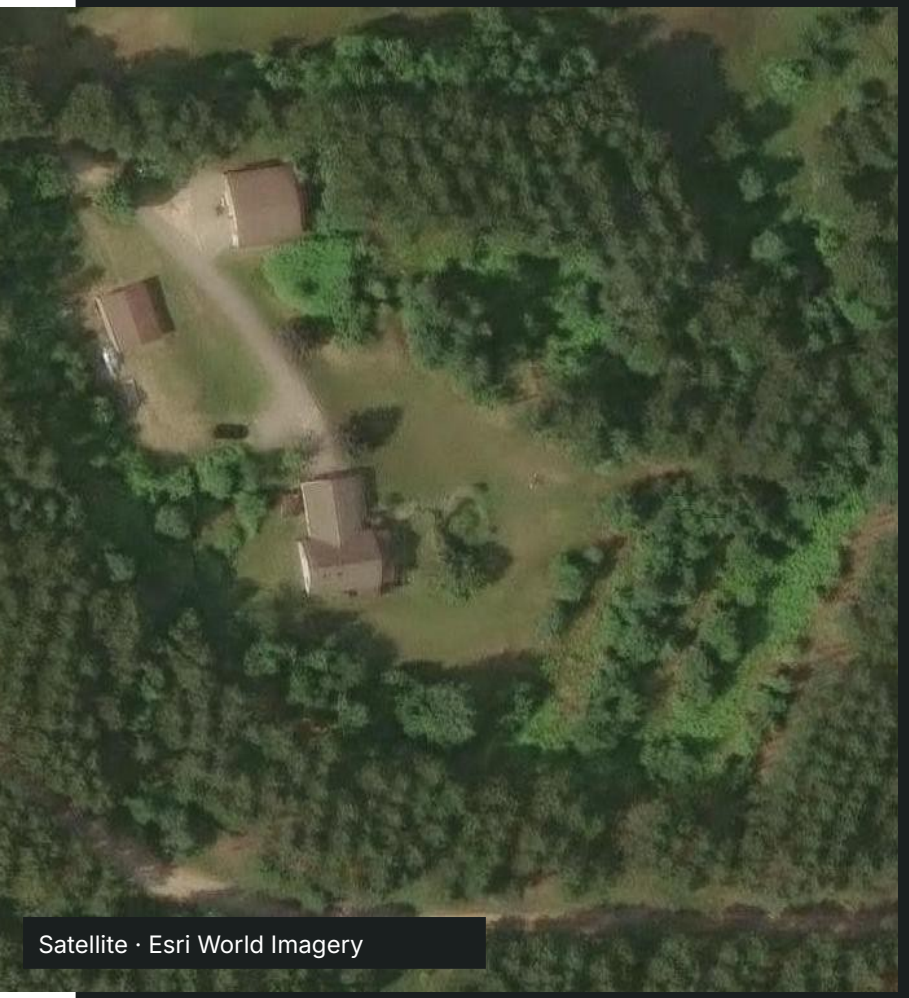
Listing photo

# 5312 Samels Rd Project Vision

Clark Huang & Jenny Roes · Williamsburg, near Traverse City, MI

October 2026

SAMELS RD



Satellite · Esri World Imagery

# Six wooded acres, a 1997 chalet, four buildings

## 6.00 acres

Wooded, sloped lot ~698 × 413 ft with ~40 ft of relief. Zoned A-1 Agricultural, Whitewater Twp. Private gravel road.

## 2,380 sf chalet

1.5-story, built 1997: 1,480 sf above grade + 900 sf walk-out lower. Metal roof, propane forced air, central air.

## 4 bed · 3 bath

2 main, 1 loft, 1 lower; 2 full + 1 ¾ bath. Lower family room 29′9″ × 19′9″. Lily pond east of the deck.

## 4 buildings

Pole barn 32 × 38 (insulated, subpanel), second garage ~28 × 30 (est.), attached 2-car garage, small shed.

# Site plan

The chalet sits mid-lot, ~200 ft off Samels Rd. Deck and walk-out face east to the pond; both barns cluster at the drive. Guest suite spot is a future option only.



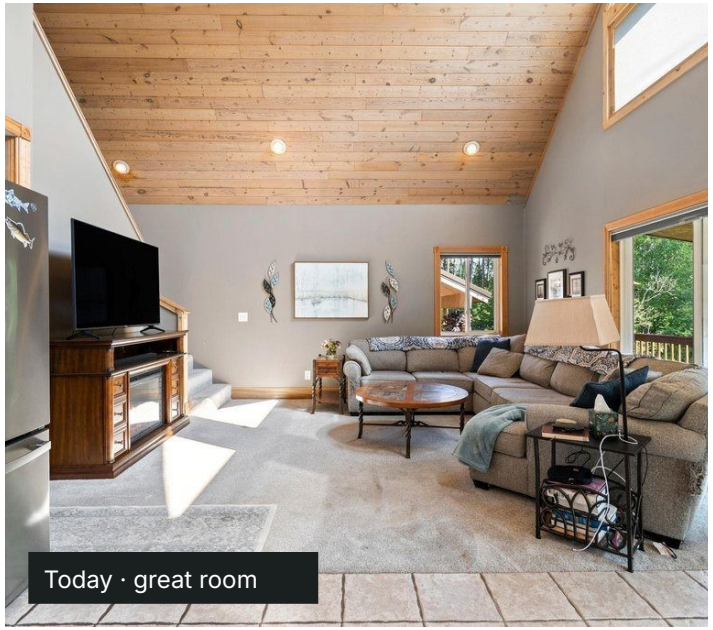

Site plan on satellite · positions approximate

# Modern, not country: one idea per level



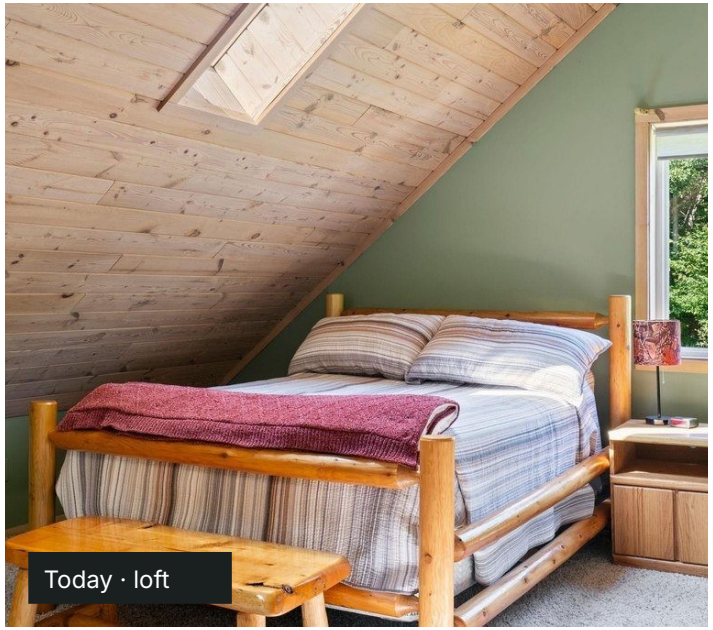

## Lower · master retreat

Clean, fresh, modern and cozy: primary suite, sitting/TV room, morning coffee at the walk-out.




## Main · entertaining

Great room as a lounge/club, island for four, no formal dining; dinners on the deck.




## Loft · guests

A calm guest loft for friends or the kids. Paint the knotty pine; warm white, charcoal, wood, muted green.

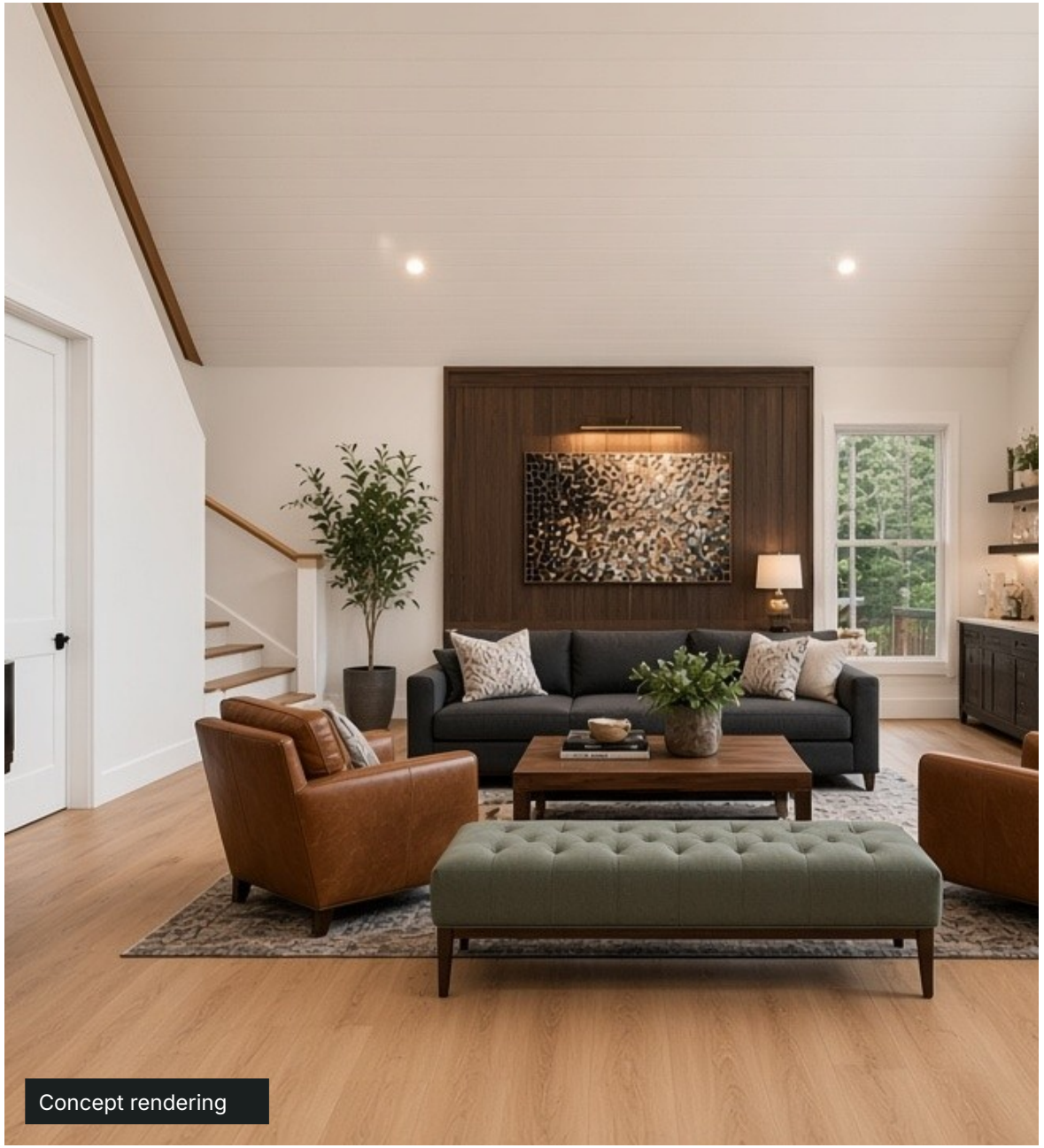
# Great room:
# a lounge, not a den

Steinway B in the former dining spot by the stair, ~12 ft from the east glass and off the registers.

Two cigar chairs, tufted bench, low club sofa; back bar on the south wall.

Seabreeze wood + mirrored mosaic panel (~4 ft wide) on the inner west wall, with a picture light.

Piano humidity: Dampp-Chaser (~$500–800, est.), 40–50% RH.



Concept rendering

# Island for four, dinner on the deck

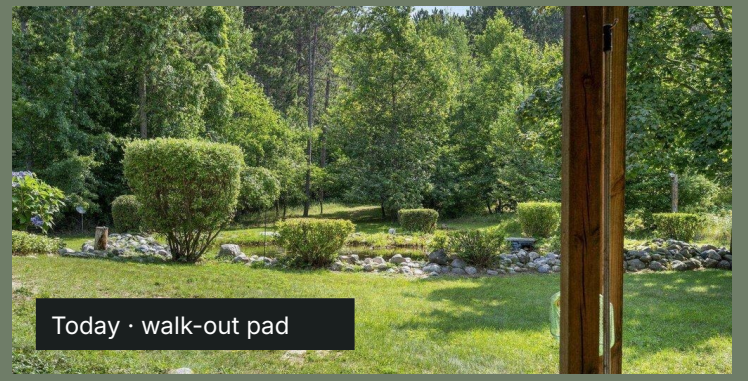
No formal dining: a 9 × 3.5 ft quartz island with four stools takes the old dining area ($6K / $11K / $20K, est.). Dinners move to a teak table on the covered wraparound deck. At ~10 ft wide (est.), an 8-ft table needs the widest corner; a 6-ft round (Hudson, $4,369) is the safe fit.


Concept rendering


Concept rendering


Concept rendering


Concept rendering


Today · walk-out pad

# Lower level: the master retreat

The lower bedroom becomes the primary suite; the 29′9″ × 19′9″ family room becomes the sitting/TV room, with a coffee nook and morning coffee at the walk-out.

Seabreeze U-sectional fits if it splits (11 × 6 ft placeholder; size not logged). Deliver through the walk-out sliders. Check the bedroom window for egress: ≥5.7 sf open, sill ≤44 in.

# Three baths, one modern family

Lower primary

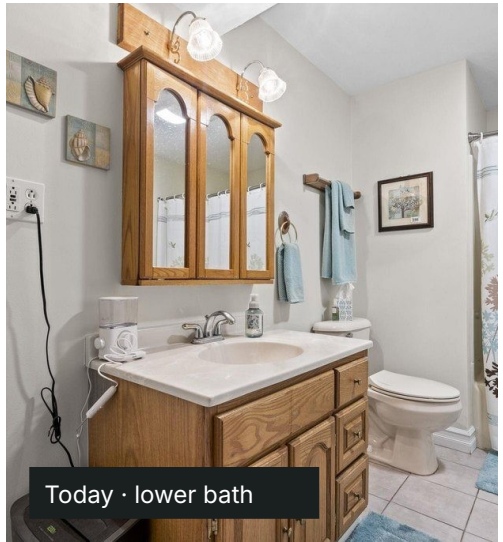
~5 × 9 ft today (est.)

Option B, mid (est.)

$49.3K, borrows craft room

Lower primary: too tight for a tub, a separate shower and two sinks. Option B borrows the craft room (~9 × 12) for a freestanding tub, acrylic shower and double vanity. Option C: walk-in shower + 60-in double vanity, no tub (~$18–30K).

Main bath: multi-piece fiberglass tub-shower; keep the gray vanity, new top. Loft ¾: shower only, new vanity. Three matching comfort-height toilets.



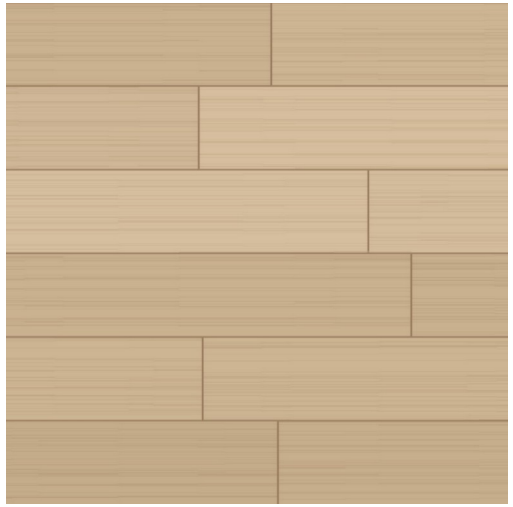
Today · lower bath



Concept rendering

# Finishes: light, quiet, continuous

Cosmetic only. Nothing structural inside the house. Mid estimates.



## Floors

~$18K mid (est.)

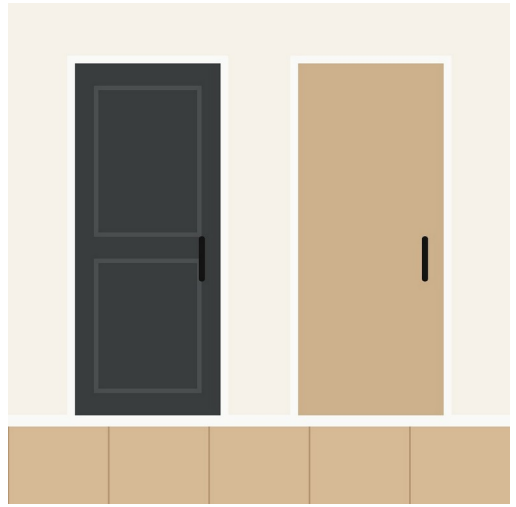
Continuous light vinyl plank, ~2,000 sf, replaces beige tile and carpet. Vapor barrier on the lower slab.




## Paint

~$15K mid (est.)

Warm white walls; paint the knotty-pine ceilings and oak trim. The biggest "modern" change per dollar.



## Doors & closets

~$13.5K mid (est.)

Modern slab or shaker doors, finished closets with doors; close off 1–2 openings, e.g. the lower French doors.



Concept rendering

# Loft: a calm guest room

For guests or the kids. Milan’s full bed with a low headboard (measure the knee wall), an optional twin daybed with trundle, a desk on the flat-ceiling side.

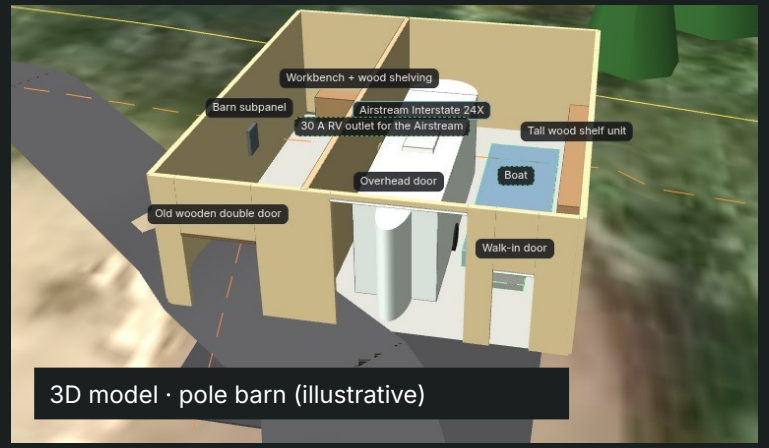
Paint the pine ceiling and knee walls. The loft ¾ bath gets a multi-piece acrylic shower (no tub) and a new vanity: $9.5K / $14.3K / $23K (est.).



Concept rendering

# Big barn: van + pontoon

Pole barn 32 × 38, insulated, with a subpanel. No structural work.




3D model · pole barn (illustrative)

### Large section

2022 Airstream Interstate 24X, a Class B camper van on a 2021 Mercedes Sprinter 3500 dually (~24 ft), plus the pontoon boat. The tall overhead door fits the van (confirmed in person).

### Divider + power

Remove the interior divider only if it is a non-load-bearing partition (~$1–3K, est.). Add 50 A shore power for the van off the barn subpanel.



Concept rendering · small-barn gym

# Small barn: CrossFit gym + recovery room

**Train:** pull-up rig as the centerpiece, barbells + bumper plates, rower/SkiErg, Peloton, curved treadmill, rubber floor. Most gear moves from Seabreeze.

**Recover:** 6 × 6 sauna and cold plunge corner. Insulation, heat and a bathroom ~$25–60K (est., excl. electrical); ~100 A subpanel.

**Permit:** no permit on record, so the second barn needs an after-the-fact permit with Grand Traverse County Construction Codes before new work.



Concept rendering

# Solar in the open field, not on the roofs

Array (concept)

~20 kW ground mount

Storage

Powerwall 3 · 13.5 kWh

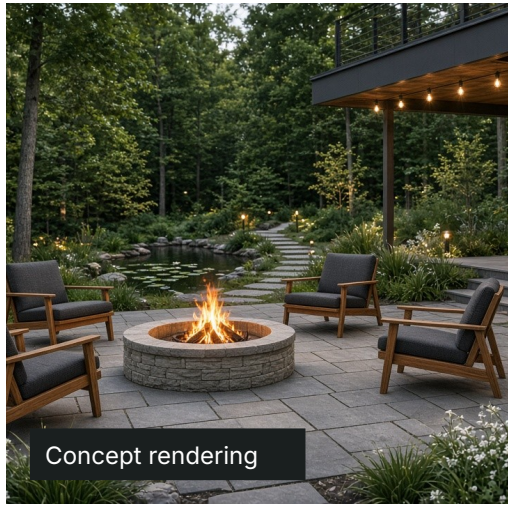
Why ground: snow and shade. A south-facing rack at 40–50° sheds snow and can be cleared by hand; wooded roofs could lose 20–50%.

Size: ~22,500 kWh/yr use → ~19 kW unshaded, 22–25 kW with shading (~50–60 panels). ~$3.00–3.80/W ≈ $60–76K for 20 kW (est.); ~20–25 yr payback.

Backup: one central Powerwall 3 at the house (~$14–17K, est.), more units later; stay grid-tied.

# A few extras worth planning

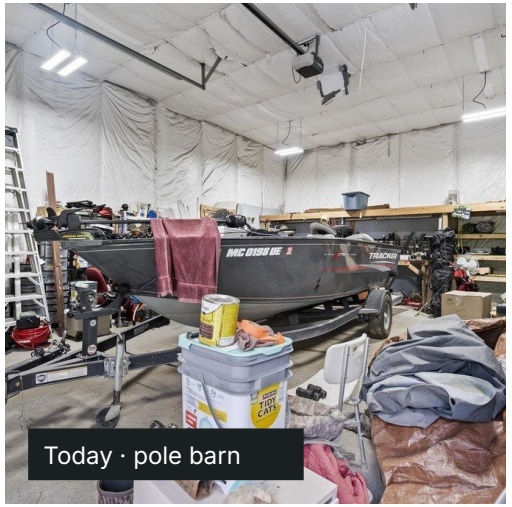
Estimate ranges (est.), not quotes.




## Fire pit + landscaping

~$16–43K (est.)

Built-in fire pit at the walk-out patio ($1.2–2.8K) plus native planting and grading ($15–40K allowance).




## EV + van power

~$1.2–3.6K (est.)

Tesla Wall Connector (60 A) in the house garage and a 50 A outlet for the van in the barn; ~$0.6–1.8K per 240 V circuit.




## Generator + lighting

~$15–24K (est.)

22–26 kW propane standby generator ($12–18K) and low-voltage path and deck lighting ($3–6K).



3D model · future suite (purple)

# Later: a guest suite (~2 years out)

### The idea

Optional ~560 sf studio (20 × 28 ft) on the chalet's west side: queen bed, plug-in kitchenette, full bath, private entry, lockable pass-through.

Only if we still love the property and want to keep investing.

### Before designing

Written ruling from the township and county: addition or second unit. Propane tank moves (~$0.5–1.5K); septic review (~$1–25K).

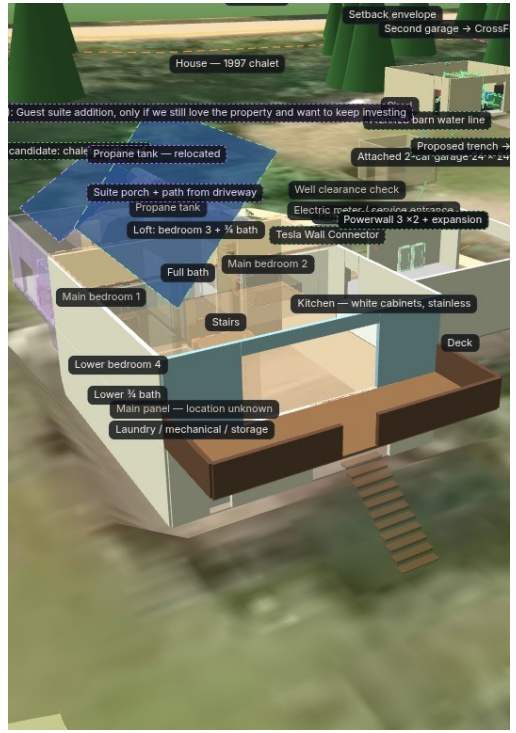
Rough cost ~$140–290K (est.), outside the $1M plan.

# Seabreeze furniture: what moves, what’s hard

Moves in: Steinway B and cigar chairs (great room), 75″ TV and console (lower), glass desk + Aeron (main-floor office), all gym gear (small barn).

Hard to fit: gray U-sectional (size not logged; walk-out delivery, or sell), massage chair (walk-out only; measure the slider), Milan’s headboard (loft knee wall), kids desk set (duplicate in a guest loft), art panel (height not logged).

Next: measure each piece at Seabreeze, then the openings at Samels.




3D model

Main level, x-ray

Inferred floor plan; positions are approximate.

# Project budget vs. $1M cap

Purchase shown at the public list price. All other lines are estimates from the Oct 26 notes, not bids. Excludes furniture, the teak set, the piano move and the future guest suite.

| Line (est.) | Low | Mid | High |
|---|---|---|---|
| Purchase · list price $619,900 | $620K | $620K | $620K |
| Interior remodel · full primary bath (B) | $115K | $187K | $315K |
| Gym barn · insulation, heat, bath | $25K | $43K | $60K |
| Electrical · 400 A service + gym trench | $6K | $11K | $15K |
| Solar · ~20 kW ground mount | $60K | $68K | $76K |
| Powerwall 3 · one unit | $14K | $15.5K | $17K |
| Extras · fire pit, landscaping, charging, generator, lighting | $32K | $51K | $70K |
| **Total project** | **~$872K** | **~$995K** | **~$1.17M** |
| **Headroom under $1M cap** | **~$128K** | **~$5K** | **over by ~$173K** |

# Next: measure, ask, then close

Measure at the visit

Lower bath + the room behind it

Lower bedroom window (egress)

Barn divider: posts on that line?

Deck width at the widest corner

Loft knee wall · walk-out slider



Ask Toni and the seller

Electrical service size, panel brand and utility?

Why was the 1999 pole-barn permit terminated? Any permits for the second garage or shed?

Septic age, size and permitted bedrooms; well depth and pump age?

Propane tank owned or leased? Road association fee and plowing?

Closing terms: traditional possession at closing, with the property vacant, all personal property removed, and in its agreed condition.

Second barn: needs an after-the-fact permit (Grand Traverse County Construction Codes).



Listing photo